

Plan Review

JM Sites • August 5, 2026

Summary

The business plan for JM Sites presents a highly articulate and modern IT consultancy. The narrative brilliantly identifies the "Conversion Gap" facing professional service firms. The proposed solution leverages a lean technology stack to deliver high-value digital assets. The transition toward a scalable SaaS product offers an exciting growth trajectory.

The strategic positioning is exceptionally strong. The business clearly understands its target audience and competitive advantages. The operational roadmap is detailed and practical. This foundation positions the firm well for securing high-ticket B2B contracts.

Risks & Concerns

The most critical risk lies in the financial forecast data. The projected cash flow shows negative cash balances from January 2026 through November 2026. The business reaches a deficit of over \$7,600 in August. This contradicts the narrative claim that the business is currently self-sustaining.

Additionally, the marketing budget appears underfunded. The forecast allocates only \$1,000 for marketing in the first year. This low figure does not support the aggressive direct outreach and networking strategy described in the plan. The funding request also lacks a specific dollar amount.

Conclusion

The narrative sections of this business plan are outstanding and ready for external review. The strategic framing is persuasive and professional. However, the financial projections require immediate revision. Aligning the forecast data with the narrative claims will make this a highly compelling funding document.

Detailed Feedback

Strong

7

Needs Improvement

1

Attention Required

2

Not Started

0

Executive Summary

Strong

A concise overview of your entire business plan that captures your value proposition, target market, competitive advantage, and financial highlights. This is often the first (and sometimes only) section funders read.

What works

The summary is exceptionally well-written. It clearly defines the problem, the solution, and the target market. The tone is professional and authoritative.

What isn't working

The summary mentions validating the methodology and launching SiteSignal. It does not mention the specific grant funding required to achieve these goals. Funders need to know the financial ask upfront.

Suggestions

1 Include the funding request

Add a brief sentence at the end of the summary detailing the specific amount of grant funding sought. State exactly what the capital will achieve.

Try saying it like this:

To accelerate the commercialization of SiteSignal, the business is seeking \$50,000 in non-dilutive grant funding to finalize technical architecture and fund initial user acquisition.

Problem & Solution

Strong

An explanation of what problem your business solves and why it matters, followed by how your specific solution addresses that problem. The Problem should focus on market gaps and customer pain points. The Solution should explain your approach, what makes it unique, and how it directly addresses the problems you've identified.

What works

The articulation of the "Conversion Gap" is brilliant. It clearly defines the pain point for professional service firms. The solution directly addresses this gap through "Performance Engineering" and conversion-focused messaging.

What isn't working

This section is exceptionally strong. It clearly communicates the value proposition without relying on overly technical jargon.

Suggestions

1 Quantify the problem

Add a brief statistic or estimate regarding how much revenue firms lose due to poor digital conversion. This adds financial weight to the problem statement.

Try saying it like this:

Industry data suggests that professional service firms lose up to 30% of potential high-ticket leads due to poor website user experience and unclear messaging.

Target Market

Strong

A detailed analysis of who your customers are, how large the market is, and why you can capture a meaningful share. Include demographics, psychographics, and market segmentation.

What works

The market segmentation is highly specific. Focusing on management consultancies and B2B tech firms with 6-50 employees provides a clear target for outreach. The geographic focus on New South Wales is practical.

What isn't working

The estimated market size of 500-1,000 qualified prospects seems arbitrarily small for the entire Australian market. Funders may view this as too niche to support long-term scaling.

Suggestions

1 Clarify market sizing

Explain the methodology behind your 500-1,000 prospect estimate. Clarify if this is your immediate serviceable market in Sydney or the total national market.

Try saying it like this:

Our immediate serviceable market consists of approximately 1,000 qualified boutique consultancies within the Sydney region, representing a localized revenue opportunity of over \$15 million.

Competition

Strong

An honest assessment of direct and indirect competitors, their strengths and weaknesses, and how you differentiate. Funders want to see you understand the competitive landscape.

What works

The analysis of the "middle-ground" dilemma is excellent. Categorizing competitors into DIY builders, freelancers, and high-overhead agencies clearly highlights the market gap. The competitive advantages are well articulated.

What isn't working

The section relies entirely on categorical competitors. It lacks specific examples of actual agencies or high-end freelancers operating in the Sydney market. Funders prefer to see real-world competitive benchmarks.

Suggestions

1 Name specific competitors

Identify two or three actual digital agencies in the New South Wales region. Explain exactly how your direct-partnership model wins against their specific offerings.

Try saying it like this:

While established Sydney agencies like Digital Garden or Bourne Digital offer enterprise-level depth, their \$50,000 minimum engagements price out boutique consultancies.

Business Model

Strong

How your company makes money. Include revenue streams, pricing strategy, unit economics, and customer acquisition costs.

What works

The tiered service model is highly effective. It provides flexible entry points for clients while building a pipeline for recurring revenue. The transition from project fees to ongoing retainers is a proven strategy for agency stability.

What isn't working

The business model narrative is very strong. It clearly outlines the value exchange. The only minor gap is the lack of specific pricing examples for the tiered engagements.

Suggestions

1 Provide pricing examples

Include baseline starting prices for your tailored engagements and fixed-scope projects. This helps funders understand your unit economics and revenue potential.

Try saying it like this:

Tailored engagements typically begin at \$15,000 for a comprehensive digital overhaul. Fixed-scope technical sprints average \$5,500 per project.

Marketing Strategy

Developing

Your go-to-market plan including positioning, channels, customer acquisition strategy, and sales process.

What works

The consultative sales approach is perfectly tailored to high-ticket B2B services. Using strategic digital audits as a lead generation tool provides immediate value and builds trust. The positioning against both cheap freelancers and expensive agencies is sharp.

What isn't working

There is a significant disconnect between the ambitious marketing strategy and the financial forecast. The forecast allocates only \$1,000 for marketing and networking in the first year. This budget is insufficient to support the described outreach, partnership building, and thought leadership activities.

Suggestions

1 Align budget with strategy

Increase the marketing expense line item in your financial forecast. Ensure the budget realistically supports your planned customer acquisition activities.

Try saying it like this:

The financial forecast allocates \$5,000 annually for marketing to support targeted LinkedIn outreach tools, networking event sponsorships, and digital audit software.

2 Define customer acquisition cost

Explain how much it costs in time and resources to acquire a single high-ticket client. This proves to funders that your marketing model is sustainable.

Try saying it like this:

Our estimated Customer Acquisition Cost is \$800, factoring in the software tools and billable hours required to conduct three strategic audits to secure one signed contract.

Operations

Strong

How your business actually runs day-to-day. Include facilities, technology, key processes, and partnerships.

What works

The operational plan is incredibly thorough. The technology stack is modern, specific, and perfectly suited for the described services. The remote-first approach keeps overhead low and aligns with the financial forecast.

What isn't working

The operations section is comprehensive and well-aligned with the business model. The milestones are clear and actionable.

Suggestions

1 Add a SiteSignal milestone

Include a specific target date for the beta launch or commercial release of SiteSignal in your milestones table. This ties your operational goals to your funding request.

Try saying it like this:

Launch the SiteSignal beta program to an initial cohort of ten existing clients. (Due: June 30, 2027)

Team

Strong

The people who will execute this plan. Include founders, key hires, advisors, and any relevant experience or track record.

What works

The founder profile is compelling and aligns perfectly with the technical requirements of the business. The inclusion of an advisory network demonstrates maturity and a willingness to seek external guidance.

What isn't working

The plan mentions scaling the team and utilizing contractors. However, the financial forecast shows \$0 for employee expenses and no clear contractor line items. This creates ambiguity about how growth will be staffed.

Suggestions

1 Clarify contractor costs

Explain how external contractors will be compensated. Ensure this explanation aligns with the direct costs or operating expenses in your financial forecast.

Try saying it like this:

As project volume increases, specialized development tasks will be outsourced to vetted freelancers. These costs are modeled within our direct project expenses to maintain high gross margins.

Financial Projections

Attention Required

Your financial forecasts including revenue projections, expenses, profitability timeline, and key assumptions.

What works

The revenue streams are clearly segmented in the forecast. The high gross margins accurately reflect a premium service-based business model. The transition to subscription revenue in year two is modeled well.

What isn't working

The cash flow forecast reveals a critical issue. The business operates with a negative cash balance from January 2026 through November 2026. The deficit reaches \$7,609 in August. This means the business cannot pay its bills during this period. The narrative claims the business is self-sustaining, which contradicts this data.

Suggestions

1 Inject starting capital

Update the financial forecast to include an initial cash injection. This could be founder capital or a startup loan to cover the first-year cash deficit.

Try saying it like this:

The financial forecast includes a \$10,000 initial capital injection from the founder to ensure positive cash flow during the early growth phase.

2 Reconcile the self-sustaining claim

Adjust the narrative to reflect the reality of the forecast. Acknowledge the early cash burn and explain how it will be managed.

Try saying it like this:

While the business will experience a brief cash deficit during initial outreach, founder reserves will cover operating expenses until profitability is reached in late 2026.

Funding Request

Attention Required

How much capital you need, how you'll use it, expected return for funders, and your exit strategy.

What works

The strategic rationale for funding is excellent. Using capital to transition from a service model to a product-led SaaS model (SiteSignal) is a compelling growth story. The planned use of funds is logical.

What isn't working

The plan never states the actual amount of grant funding required. Furthermore, the financial forecast does not include any grant income. Funders cannot evaluate a request without knowing the specific dollar amount and seeing it modeled in the cash flow.

Suggestions

1 Specify the funding amount

State the exact dollar amount of grant funding you are seeking. Break down how this specific amount will be divided among your stated goals.

Try saying it like this:

The business is seeking a \$50,000 commercialization grant. This will be allocated toward backend infrastructure (\$20,000), cybersecurity compliance (\$15,000), and initial market validation (\$15,000).

2 Add grant funding to the forecast

Update your LivePlan forecast to include the requested grant funding as a financing event or other income. This ensures your narrative matches your numbers.

Try saying it like this:

The projected cash flow statement reflects the anticipated receipt of a \$50,000 non-dilutive grant in the second quarter of 2027.

Funder Q&A Prep

Challenging questions funders will ask about your plan. Use the pro-tips to prepare strong, confident answers.

1 Your financial forecast shows a negative cash balance for the first eleven months of operation. How will the business fund this initial deficit?

Pro-Tip: Acknowledge the cash gap directly. Explain whether you will inject personal founder capital or secure a startup loan to cover early operating expenses.

- 2** The plan mentions seeking non-dilutive grant funding for SiteSignal. Exactly how much capital are you requesting?

Pro-Tip: Provide a specific funding target. Break down exactly how those funds will be allocated across development, marketing, and infrastructure.

- 3** Your first-year marketing budget is only \$1,000. How will you execute your high-touch consultative sales strategy with such limited funds?

Pro-Tip: Explain your customer acquisition cost. Detail how you will leverage low-cost channels like LinkedIn outreach and strategic partnerships effectively.

- 4** As a sole proprietorship, what is your maximum capacity for concurrent custom website projects?

Pro-Tip: Define your monthly billable hour limit. Show funders you understand your operational bottlenecks and have a plan to manage waitlists.

- 5** SiteSignal is projected to generate nearly \$10,000 in its first year. What is the specific go-to-market strategy for this new product?

Pro-Tip: Separate your service marketing from your product marketing. Detail the specific channels and beta-testing phases planned for the software launch.

- 6** You mention scaling the team eventually. Why are there no contractor or employee expenses listed in the three-year financial forecast?

Pro-Tip: Clarify your labor model. If you plan to use contractors, explain how those costs are factored into your direct costs or operating expenses.